MIL-B-43663A
12 August 1982
SUPERSEDING
MIL-B-43663
14 August 1969

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

BAGS, TOOL, SATCHEL

This specification is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This document covers satchel tool bags fabricated from cotton duck cloth.

1.2 Classification. The tool bags shall be of the following types, as specified (see 6.2).

Type I	-	2 pockets, slide fastener closure, 2 cotton webbing handles
Type II	-	1 compartment, strap fastening closure, cotton webbing handgrip and shoulder strap, fiberboard framework
Type III	-	1 compartment, leather strap fastening closure, 2 harness leather handles, rigid steel frame mouth with leather reinforced bottom and sides.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Government documents. Unless otherwise specified, the following documents of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this document to the extent specified herein.

Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document should be addressed to: US Army Natick Research and Development Laboratories, Natick, MA 01760 by using the self-addressed Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document or by letter.

FSC 5140

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SPECIFICATIONS

FEDERAL

UU-P-268	-	Paper, Kraft, Wrapping
DDD-L-20	-	Label: For Clothing, Equipage and Tentage (General Use)
PPP-B-636	-	Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard

STANDARDS

FEDERAL

FED-STD-751	-	Stitches, Seams, and Stitchings

MILITARY

MIL-STD-105	-	Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes
MIL-STD-129	-	Marking for Shipment and Storage
MIL-STD-147	-	Palletized Unit Loads
MIL-STD-1188	-	Commercial Packaging of Supplies and Equipment

DRAWINGS

US ARMY NATICK RESEARCH AND DEVELOPMENT LABORATORIES

2-3-219	-	Bags, Tool, Satchel; Type I, Assembly and Sections
2-3-220	-	Details
2-3-305	-	Bags, Tool, Satchel; Type II, Assembly, Complete
2-3-306	-	Details
2-3-307	-	Details and Sections
2-3-308	-	Sections
2-3-309	-	Bags, Tool, Satchel; Type III, Assembly, Complete
2-3-310	-	Details "A"
2-3-311	-	Details "B"
2-3-312	-	Sections

(Copies of documents required by manufacturers in connection with specific acquisition functions should be obtained from the contracting activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Order of precedence. In the event of a conflict between the text of this document and the references cited herein, the text of this document shall take precedence.

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 First article. When specified, a sample shall be subjected to first article inspection (see 4.3, 6.2 and 6.3).

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3.2 Materials and components. Materials (see 6.4) and components shall be as specified on the applicable drawings.

3.3 Construction. The construction shall conform in all respects to the drawings listed in 2.1 and as specified herein.

3.3.1 Stitches, seams and stitchings. All seams and stitching, shall conform to FED-STD-751: type 301 with 8 to 10 stitches per inch.

3.3.1.1 Type 301 stitching. Ends of stitching shall be backstitched or overstitched not less than 1 inch (1/2 inch for box and box-x stitching) except where ends are turned under or caught in other seams or stitching. Thread tensions shall be maintained so that there will be no loose stitching resulting in loose bobbin or top thread or excessively tight stitching resulting in puckering of the materials sewn. The lock shall be imbedded in the materials sewed.

3.3.1.1.1 Repairs of type 301 stitching. Repairs of type 301 stitching shall be as follows:

a. When thread breaks or bobbin run-outs occur during stitching, except presewing, the stitching shall be repaired by restarting the stitching a minimum of one inch (1/2 inch for box and box-x stitching) back of the end of the stitching. 1/

b. Thread breaks, or two or more consecutive skipped or run-off stitches noted during inspection of the item (in-process or end item) shall be repaired by overstitching. The stitching shall start a minimum of one inch in back of the defective area (1/2 inch on box and box-x stitching), continue over the defective area and continue a minimum of one inch beyond the defective area onto the existing stitching. Loose or excessively tight stitching shall be repaired by removing the defective stitching, without damaging the materials, and restitching in the required manner. 1/

1/ When making the above repairs, the ends of the stitching are not required to be backstitched.

3.3.1.2 Automatic stitching. Automatic machines may be used to perform any of the stitch patterns provided the requirements for the stitch pattern, stitches per inch, and size and type of thread are met; and at least three or more tying, overlapping or backstitches are used to secure the ends of the stitching.

3.3.1.3 Thread ends. All thread ends shall be trimmed to 1/4 inch maximum length.

3.3.1.4 Lubrication of thread. There shall be no lubrication of the thread by any means, prior to or during sewing (see 4.4.1.1).

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3.3.2 Setting of end clips. Webbing shall be inserted the full depth of the clip. The clips shall be securely attached without cutting the webbing and the webbing shall be flat at the point of entrance.

3.3.3 Setting of rivets. Rivets shall be securely set and neatly headed.

3.3.4 Marking. The identification marking shall be applied in the location shown on the applicable drawing and shall conform to type IV, class 5 of DDD-L-20. The letters "US" shall be applied in the size characters and in the location indicated on the applicable drawing and shall conform to type IV, class 9 of DDD-L-20. Fastness of class 9 marking shall be as specified for class 5 marking.

3.3.5 Location marks. Locations marks shall not be drilled. Printed markings shall not be more than 1/32 inch in width.

3.3.6 Repairs. Repairs such as mends, darns, patches or splices are not permitted on the tool bag.

3.3.7 Replacement of defective components. During the spreading, cutting and manufacturing process, components having material defects or damages that are classified as defects in 4.4.3.1 shall be removed from production and replaced with non-defective and properly matched components.

3.4 Workmanship. The tool bags shall conform to the quality of product established by this document and the occurrence of defects shall not exceed the applicable acceptable quality levels.

4. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the document where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 Certificate of compliance. When certificates of compliance are submitted, the Government reserves the right to check test such items to determine the validity of the certification.

4.2 Classification of inspection. The inspection requirements specified herein are classified as follows:

a. First article inspection (see 4.3).
b. Quality conformance inspection (see 4.4).

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4.3 First article inspection. When a first article is required (see 6.2), it shall be examined for the defects specified in 4.4.3.1 and 4.4.3.2. The presence of any defect shall be cause for rejection of the first article.

4.4 Quality conformance inspection. Unless otherwise specified, sampling for inspection shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-105.

4.4.1 Component and material inspection. In accordance with 4.1, components and materials shall be inspected in accordance with all the requirements of referenced documents unless otherwise excluded, amended, modified, or qualified in this document or applicable purchase document.

4.4.1.1 Certification. The contractor shall furnish a certificate of compliance for the requirement specified in 3.3.1.4.

4.4.2 In-process inspection. Examination shall be made of the following operations to establish conformance to specified requirements. Whenever nonconformance is noted, correction shall be made to the items affected, the lot in process and to the operation. Parts which cannot be corrected shall be removed from production.

a. Dimensional examination of parts for which a cut length or size is specified to determine conformance with specified dimensions.

b. Visual examination of cut parts to remove parts containing material defects and damages (see 3.3.7).

c. Visual examination of the corner reinforcements (type II bag) are given a phosphate treated zinc plate prior to enameling.

d. Visual examination of the handle reinforcement (type II bag) is given a zinc plating.

4.4.3 End item examination. The end item shall be examined in accordance with 4.4.3.1 and 4.4.3.2. The lot size shall be expressed in units of one bag. The sample unit shall be one bag.

4.4.3.1 Visual examination. The end item shall be examined for the defects listed below. The inspection level shall be II and the acceptable quality level (AQL) shall be 4.0 for major defects and 10.0 total (major and minor combined) defects on type I bags. Type II and III bags shall be 6.5 for major defects and 15.0 for total (major and minor combined) defects.

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Examine	Defect	Classification Major	Minor
Fabric	Hole, cut, tear, smash, broken or missing yarn, or open place clearly visible at normal inspection distance (approximately 3 feet)	X	
Webbing or tape	Any hole, cut, tear, or smash	X	
	Not firmly and tightly woven	X	
	Edges frayed or scalloped	X	
	Multiple floats		X
	Abrasion mark, slub, or broken end or pick		X
	Cut ends of nylon webbing not fused		X
Hardware (general)	Broken or malformed failing to serve intended purpose, corroded area, burr, or sharp edge	X	
	Finished omitted or not as specified:		
	- on brass		X
	- on steel components	X	
	Area of partial or no finish		X
	Any required component improperly installed causing failure to serve intended purpose	X	
	Not assembled as specified	X	
	Size or type not as specified	X	
	Rivets and caps not securely clinched so that they may become disengaged from body; or clinched excessively tight, cutting material	X	
	End clips not securely clinched; webbing not flat at point of insertion; clinched excessively tight, cutting webbing		X
Slide fastener	Not functioning properly, failing to effect a secure closure, or to open freely	X	
	NOTE: The slide fastener shall be fully closed and opened to determine if fastener operates smoothly and provides a secure closure.		

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Examine	Defect	Classification Major	Minor
Slide fastener (cont'd)	Not specified type or size	X	
	Any portion of fastener broke, bent missing or not aligned	X	
	Slider jams or fails to interlock scoops	X	
	Thong omitted	X	
	Fastener tape cut or torn	X	
Open seam	1/2 inch or less		X
	More than 1/2 inch	X	
	NOTE: A seam shall be classified as open when one or more stitches joining a seam are broken or when two or more consecutive skipped or runoff stitches occur. On double stitched seams, a seam shall be considered open when either one or both sides of the seam are open.		
Raw edge (on edge required to be finished)	More than 1/2 inch when securely caught in stitching		X
	NOTE: Raw edge not securely caught in stitching shall be classified as an open seam.		
Run-off (see open seam)			
Seam and stitch type	Wrong seam or stitch type	X	
Stitch tension	Loose, resulting in a loose bobbin or top thread		X
	Excessively tight, resulting in puckering of material		X
Stitches per inch	One stitch less than minimum specified		X
	Two or more stitches less than minimum specified	X	
	One or more stitches in excess of maximum specified		X

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Examine	Defect	Classification Major	Classification Minor
Stitches per inch (cont'd)			
	NOTE: Variation in the number of stitches per inch caused by the operator speeding up the machine and pulling the fabric in order to sew over heavy seams, or in turning corners shall be classified as follows:		
	(a) Within the minor defect classification - no defect		
	(b) Within the major defect classification - minor defect		
Stitching ends	Not secured as specified		X
Thread breaks, skipped stitches or runoffs	Not overstitched as specified		X
	NOTE: Thread breaks or two or more consecutive skipped or runoff stitches not overstitched shall be classified as open seams.		
Rows of stitching	Any row missing except on box and box-x stitching	X	
	On box and box-x stitching:		
	- One row of stitching omitted		X
	- Two or more rows of stitching omitted	X	
Components and assembly	Any component part omitted or not as specified or any required operation omitted (unless otherwise classified herein)	X	
	Needle chews	X	
	Any mend, darn, patch or splice	X	
Binding	Loosely applied but not exposing raw edge of material		X
	Loosely applied exposing raw edge of material	X	
Marking	Omitted, illegible, incorrect, or misplaced		X

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Examine	Defect	Classification Major	Minor
Location markings	Drilled	X	
	Printed marking more than 1/32 inch in width		X
Cleanness	Any spot or stain clearly noticeable		X
Thread ends	Not trimmed to 1/4 inch maximum length		X

4.4.3.2 Dimensional examination. Examination shall be made for compliance with all dimensions shown on the drawings which can be examined on the end item, including stitch margins and gauge, excluding reference dimensions. Any dimension exceeding the applicable tolerance shall constitute a defect. The inspection level shall be S-3 and the AQL shall be 4.0 defects per hundred units.

4.4.4 Packaging inspection. An examination shall be made to determine that preservation, packing and marking requirements comply with the section 5 requirements. Defects shall be scored in accordance with the list below. The sample unit shall be one shipping container fully packaged with the exception that it need not be closed. Examination of closure defects listed below shall be made on shipping containers fully packaged. The lot size shall be the number of containers in the inspection lot. The inspection level shall be S-2 and the AQL shall be 2.5 defects per hundred units.

Examine	Defect
Marking (exterior and interior)	Omitted; incorrect; illegible; of improper size, location, sequence, or method of application.
Materials	Any component missing, damaged, or not as specified.
Workmanship	Inadequate application of components, such as: incomplete closure of container flaps, improper taping, loose strapping, or inadequate stapling. Bulged or distorted container.
Content	Number of tool bags per container is more or less than specified.

4.4.5 Palletization examination. An examination shall be made to determine that palletization complies with the section 5 requirements. Defects shall be scored in accordance with the list below. The sample unit shall be one palletized unit load fully packaged. The lot size shall be the number of the palletized unit loads in the end item inspection lot. The inspection level shall be S-1 and the AQL shall be 6.5 defects per hundred units.

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Examine	Defect
Finished dimensions	Length, width, or height exceeds specified maximum requirement.
Palletization	Pallet pattern not as specified. Interlocking of loads not as specified. Load not bonded with required straps as specified.
Weight	Exceeds maximum load limits.
Marking	Omitted; incorrect; illegible; of improper size, location, sequence, or method of application.

5. PACKAGING

5.1 Preservation. Preservation shall be level A or Commercial as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Level A.

5.1.1.1 Type I bag. Each bag, with fastener closed, shall have one side and the top pushed inward lengthwise against the base and the opposite side. The latter side is to be folded down with the tape handles inside the resulting flat-folded bag. The two ends of the flattened bag should result as protruding angles and with no unnecessary distortions along the slide fastener length. The knocked-down bag shall measure approximately 25 by 7-1/4 by 1 inches.

5.1.1.2 Type II bag. Each bag with the carrying strap coiled and placed in the bag, shall have the closing straps securely fastened.

5.1.1.3 Type III. Each bag, with straps fastened, shall have the handle and frame portion collapsed over the base of the bag. The width of the flattened bag shall be 8-3/4 inches. Each folded bag shall be inserted in a close-fitting and end-opening fiberboard box conforming to style RSC, type CF (variety SW), class domestic, grade 200 of PPP-B-636. Each box shall be secured with gummed paper tape conforming to type III, grade B of PPP-T-45.

5.1.2 Commercial. The tool bags shall be preserved in accordance with MIL-STD-1188.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B or Commercial as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 Level A packing.

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5.2.1.1 Types I and II bags. Tool bags of one type only, preserved as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a snug-fitting fiberboard shipping container conforming to style RSC-L, grade V2s of PPP-B-636. The inside of each shipping container shall be fitted with a box liner conforming to type CF, class weather-resistant, variety DW, grade V15c of PPP-B-636. Level A unit packs shall be packed flat, reversed side to side to achieve a balanced pack within a shipping container. Each container shall have the contents completely covered on the top and bottom with a sheet of 30-pound minimum basis weight kraft paper conforming to type I, grade B of UU-P-268. Each shipping container shall be closed in accordance with method III, waterproofed in accordance with method V, and reinforced as specified in the appendix of PPP-B-636 except the inspection shall be in accordance with 4.4.4. The weight of contents of each shipping container shall not exceed 65 pounds.

5.2.1.2 Type III bags. Tool bags, preserved as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a snug-fitting fiberboard shipping container as specified in 5.1.1.1, except the box liner shall not be required. Each shipping container shall be closed, waterproofed and reinforced as specified in 5.1.1.1. The weight of contents of each shipping container shall not exceed 65 pounds.

5.2.2 Level B packing.

5.2.2.1 Type I and II bags. Tool bags of one type only, preserved as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a snug-fitting fiberboard shipping container conforming to style RSC-L, type CF (variety SW), or SF, class domestic, grade 275 of PPP-B-636. The inside of each shipping container shall be fitted with a box liner conforming to type CF, class domestic, variety DW, grade 275 of PPP-B-636. Level A unit packs shall be packed flat, reversed side to side to achieve a balanced pack within a shipping container. Each shipping container shall have the contents completely covered on the top and bottom with a sheet of 30-pound minimum basis weight kraft paper conforming to type I, grade B of UU-P-268. Each shipping container shall be closed in accordance with method II as specified in the appendix of PPP-B-636, except the inspection shall be in accordance with 4.4.4. The weight of the contents of each shipping container shall not exceed 65 pounds.

5.2.2.2 Type III bag. Tool bags, preserved as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a snug-fitting fiberboard shipping container as specified in 5.2.2.1, except the box liner shll not be required. Closure and weight of contents of each shipping container shall be as specified in 5.2.2.1.

5.2.2.3 Weather-resistant fiberboard containers. When specified (see 6.2), the shipping container shall be a grade V3c, V3s, or V4s fiberboard box fabricated in accordance with PPP-B-636 and closed in accordance with method III as specified in the appendix of PPP-B-636, except the inspection shall be in accordance with 4.4.4.

5.2.3 Commercial packing. Tool bags, preserved as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in accordance with MIL-STD-1188.

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5.3 Palletization. When specified (see 6.2), tool bags packed as specified in 5.2, shall be palletized in accordance with load type I of MIL-STD-147. Each prepared load shall be bonded with primary and secondary straps in accordance with bonding means K and L. Pallet patterns shall be in accordance with the appendix of MIL-STD-147. Interlocking of loads shall be affected by reversing the pattern of each course. If the container is of a size which does not conform to any of the pallet patterns specified in MIL-STD-147, the pallet pattern used shall first be approved by the contracting officer.

5.4 Marking. In addition to any special marking required by the contract or purchase order, unit packs, shipping containers and palletized unit loads shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129 or MIL-STD-1188, as applicable.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. The tool bags covered by this document are used as components of various tool sets, kits or equipment to store and to protect the tools from damage and the elements.

6.2 Ordering data. Acquisition documents should specify the following:

(a) Title, number and date of this document.
(b) Size required (see 1.2).
(c) When a first article sample is required (see 3.1, 4.3, and 6.3).
(d) Selection of applicable levels of preservation and packing (see 5.1 and 5.2).
(e) When weather-resistant grade fiberboard shipping containers are required for level B packing (see 5.2.2.1).
(f) When palletization is required (see 5.3).

6.3 First article. When a first article is required, it shall be inspected and approved under the appropriate provisions of DAR 7-104.55. The first article should be a preproduction sample consisting of one complete bag. The contracting officer should include specific instructions in all acquisition documents regarding arrangements for inspection and approval of the first article.

6.4 Recycled material. It is encouraged that recycled material be used when practical as long as it meets the requirements of the document (see 3.3).

6.5 Changes from previous issue. Asterisks are not used in this revision to identify changes with respect to the previous issue due to the extensiveness of the changes.

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DOCUMENT IDENTIFIER *(Number)* AND TITLE

MIL-B-43663A Bags, Tool, Satchel

NAME OF ORGANIZATION AND ADDRESS OF SUBMITTER

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1. ☐ HAS ANY PART OF THE DOCUMENT CREATED PROBLEMS OR REQUIRED INTERPRETATION IN PROCUREMENT USE? ☐ IS ANY PART OF IT TOO RIGID, RESTRICTIVE, LOOSE OR AMBIGUOUS? PLEASE EXPLAIN BELOW.

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2. REMARKS

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